

as the industry standard, and it is this standard that allows courseware of all types to be loaded into a SCORM compatible LMS. These specifications ensure that the LMS can communicate with the course content, and thus perform its actions as per requirement.

So basically, creating an online course of your own consists of developing the instructional content, and then choosing the perfect LMS for your content. Sounds simple right? Let's look at how you can get down to doing this.

There are a lot of companies that make course content for you, but luckily for those who want to make their own course content, there are loads of authoring tools available online that might just do the trick. Courses can be built using HTML, Javascript or the likes, but even if you aren't a programmer, there is a way out. An authoring tool is a program that usually has pre-programmed elements to aid in the development of interactive multimedia software, thus allowing a non-programmer to create software with programming features.

These are a few of the more popular authoring tools out there. Note: All of these either support SCORM or have packages that can be downloaded that enable you to publish your content in SCORM.

- ▶ **Adobe Captivate:** Initially one of the most popular software packages for software simulations and Powerpoint conversions, its latest packages as with the addition of customizable actions and variables isn't the greatest in terms of scope or power. It integrates seamlessly with Adobe Audition CS6, and has extremely good zooming and panning features. It has the ability to create both Flash and HTML5 content but one of the perks about it is that it actually has the ability to detect which version is supported by the user's device.
- ▶ **Articulate Storyline:** Though Storyline is standalone software, its interface is based on powerpoint and thus is incredibly easy to get started with. It builds on the Powerpoint interface in a highly intuitive manner, offering loads of powerpacked features to build amazing learning experiences while being extremely easy to use. It has brilliant screen recording, and can publish to Flash or HTML5 and even iOS. Icing on the cake is the support of an extremely enthusiastic user community.
- ▶ **Lectora Inspire:** This software doesn't have great graphic development

